resources. A unilateral action by the upper riparian state (India) which impairs the lower riparian state does not conform with international norms.

In the days to come, several such telegrams were received by New Delhi indicating the increasing involvement of the USA and China in the bilateral affairs of India and Bangladesh.

The Shockwaves

A.K. Verma, a deputy director of the R&AW who became the head of the spy agency in 1987, said that the coup was the handiwork of the major rank officers. Other senior officers of the armed forces were not taken into confidence though some key anonymous officers of the army command at Dhaka were in the picture. Verma's investigation revealed the major instrument of the coup was the Bengal Lancers and its commanding officer, Major Farooq Rahman, but no troops or equipment from outside were utilised. Interestingly, spymaster Verma discovered that there had been no plans to take over the centres of power in other big cities and towns. The top military officers at Dhaka, who were taken by surprise by the coup, agreed to transfer their allegiance to the new government when presented with a fait accompli.

A month after the coup, Verma drafted a nine-page secret note for the various Indian government agencies responsible for national security. In Verma's analysis, Mostaq, who took over as the president after Mujib was killed, was privy to the planning of the coup. He also said that Major Farooq Rahman, one of the key plotters, was Mostaq's nephew and the manner in which they were able to establish quick control over the administration in the country and the ease with which Mostaq settled down as president strongly indicated prior knowledge